

Wednesday, 7 October 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Rain 18° 10°	BIRMINGHAM Drizzle 16° 9°	MANCHESTER Light rain 14° 10°	GLASGOW Light drizzle 12° 9°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

The Conservatives are pledging to spend ten billion pounds on a new British anti-missile defence system.

They say the plan would protect the UK at a time when other Nato allies have warned of Russian drone incursions. The announcement comes ahead of the next general election.

POLITICS · UK
- 2

A court has heard that Iranian men accused of spying targeted journalists for 'serious violence' in the UK.

The prosecution says the targets were journalists working for a satellite channel critical of the Iranian government. This comes after a series of arrests related to national security concerns.

CRIME · UK
- 3

Two police officers have been sacked after using a Taser and baton on a 92-year-old amputee at his care home.

A disciplinary hearing found that both PCs used unnecessary force on Donald Burgess. The incident has sparked widespread concern and calls for greater accountability.

POLICE · UK
- 4

Three Afghan men have been jailed for the rape of a teenager after being caught fleeing the UK by French police.

The men tried to escape Britain in a lorry after their crimes but were stopped by French authorities. This case highlights ongoing cross-border efforts to tackle serious crime.

CRIME · UK
- 5

New statistics reveal that one million people in the UK who have never smoked are now vaping.

For the second year in a row, more over-16s are now vaping than smoking. Health experts continue to debate the long-term implications of this trend.

HEALTH · UK

What's coming up

1 In a massive Hollywood shake-up, Paramount has officially taken over Warner Bros in a 110-billion-dollar merger.

This deal brings together two of the biggest movie studios after months of legal disputes and competition concerns. It's expected to significantly alter the entertainment landscape.

ON AIR – What do you think this huge merger could mean for the films and TV shows we see in the future?

FILM · COMING UP

2 Rosie O'Donnell and Julie Hesmondhalgh are set to appear in a new four-hour play about the Gisele Pelicot case.

The one-off performance will also star Adjoa Andoh and Juliet Stevenson. It promises to be a powerful and thought-provoking theatrical event.

ON AIR – With such a strong cast, do you think this play will be one of the must-see theatre events of the year?

THEATRE · COMING UP

3 Former Little Mix star Jade Thirlwall says working on a song for the new 'Blue Planet III' documentary was 'magical'.

She collaborated with legendary composer Hans Zimmer on an official track for the BBC nature series. It's a big step for Jade into the world of film soundtracks.

ON AIR – Are you excited to hear Jade Thirlwall's contribution to the new Blue Planet soundtrack?

MUSIC · COMING UP

4 Kanye West's planned concerts in Russia have now been officially cancelled after weeks of uncertainty.

Chaos has surrounded the St Petersburg shows since the stadium stated it had not agreed to host the rapper. Fans will be disappointed by the news.

ON AIR – Are you surprised by the cancellation of Kanye West's Russian shows, or did you expect it given the previous confusion?

MUSIC · COMING UP

5 The director of the new 'Resident Evil' movie says he was completely unprepared for the backlash from fans.

While the video game adaptation has been a hit with critics, director Zach Cregger admits the fan response caught him by surprise. It seems loyal fans have strong opinions!

ON AIR – When a beloved video game or book is adapted for the screen, do you think directors should always prioritise fan expectations?

FILM · COMING UP

On the schedule

1 **Harry Kane is set to equal Peter Shilton's long-standing record as England's most-capped men's player tonight.**

Kane will reach this significant milestone if he plays against the Czech Republic. It marks another incredible achievement in his career, having already become England's all-time top scorer.

ON AIR – What do you think is Harry Kane's greatest achievement for England so far?

FOOTBALL · UK

2 **A number of Premier League clubs are reportedly pushing for Manchester City to face retrospective and future punishments.**

This comes amid ongoing investigations into alleged financial breaches by the club. The outcome could have significant implications for the league.

ON AIR – Do you think Manchester City should face retrospective punishments if they are found to have breached financial rules?

FOOTBALL · UK

3 **World number one Jannik Sinner will miss the rest of the 2026 season due to an ongoing right knee injury.**

This is a big blow for the Italian tennis star, who has had an impressive year. Fans will be hoping for his swift recovery ahead of the next season.

ON AIR – How much of an impact do you think Jannik Sinner's absence will have on the rest of the tennis season?

TENNIS · UK

4 **USA Ryder Cup captain Jim Furyk says his team will be 'underdogs' when they try to end their European drought next year.**

The Americans haven't won on European soil in over 30 years. The 2027 edition will be held at Adare Manor in Ireland.

ON AIR – Do you agree with Jim Furyk that the USA will be the underdogs at the next Ryder Cup in Europe?

GOLF · UK

5 **Uefa has confirmed it's investigating a half-time incident during Sunday's Nations League game between Republic of Ireland and Israel.**

The investigation follows an accusation of spitting during the match. It's an unwelcome distraction from the football itself.

ON AIR – How seriously do you think governing bodies like Uefa should come down on incidents like spitting in football?

FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 Scientists are exploring the fascinating phenomenon of 'déjà vu' and its connection to how our brains process memories.**
It turns out those fleeting moments of feeling like you've experienced something before might just be your brain doing a quick memory check, rather than a glimpse into the future. Researchers suggest it's a common glitch in our grey matter.
- 2 A new study reveals the surprising comfort many people find in the gentle hum of household appliances.**
From the quiet thrum of a fridge to the distant whir of a washing machine, these background noises can apparently create a sense of calm and routine for some. It's the soundtrack of home!
- 3 The delightful trend of 'curated picnics' is sweeping the nation, with enthusiasts sharing their beautifully arranged outdoor meals.**
Forget soggy sandwiches! People are lovingly packing gourmet treats, charming tableware, and even decorative blankets for their al fresco dining adventures. It's all about the aesthetic, as well as the delicious food.
- 4 There's a quiet appreciation growing for the 'art of perfectly folded laundry', with many finding it a soothing and satisfying chore.**
Far from a mundane task, some individuals genuinely enjoy the neatness and order that comes from a crisply folded pile of clothes. It's a small victory in a busy day!
- 5 New research suggests that 'mindful daydreaming' can actually boost creativity and problem-solving skills.**
It seems allowing your mind to wander in a focused way, rather than aimlessly, can unlock new ideas and perspectives. So, next time you're 'staring into space', you might just be doing some serious thinking!
- 6 The unexpected joy of 'successfully mending a favourite item of clothing' is being celebrated by a growing community.**
Instead of throwing things away, more people are embracing the satisfaction of repairing a beloved jumper or trousers. It's a sustainable and heartwarming trend.
- 7 Experts are looking into the 'comforting power of a familiar scent' to trigger positive emotions and memories.**
Whether it's the smell of freshly baked bread, an old perfume, or even damp earth after rain, certain aromas have a remarkable ability to transport us back to happy times. It's like a memory in a whiff!

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new television series, especially if it's a much-anticipated one. What is it?

ANSWER: REARRANGING THE CUSHIONS ON THE SOFA 'JUST SO' FOR OPTIMAL VIEWING COMFORT.

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when trying to quickly judge if a new brand of sparkling water will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific? What is it?

ANSWER: GIVING THE BOTTLE A LITTLE 'SWISH AND LISTEN' TO HEAR THE FIZZ.

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes you stumble upon a 'hidden gem' in your local area – a little shop, a quiet park, or a charming cafe – that you wish more people knew about?
What's your best-kept local secret? We'd love to hear about the places in your neighbourhood that truly deserve a bit more spotlight, and why they're so special to you!

- We all have those 'little rituals' that just make the start or end of our day feel complete, whether it's how you make your morning cuppa or your evening wind-down routine.
What's your favourite, slightly quirky, daily ritual? Is it a particular way you read the morning paper, or a special mug for your evening hot chocolate? Share your comforting habits with us!

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **History.** Did you know that in Ancient Rome, purple dye was so expensive and rare that only emperors and senators were allowed to wear it? It was a true symbol of power and luxury.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Did you know that the first ever post box in the UK was actually a hollowed-out tree trunk, with a small door and a slot, installed in a village in Devon in the 17th century?

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£25 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- A group of flamingos is called a 'flamboyance', which seems perfectly fitting for such colourful birds.
- The world's smallest chameleon, the Brookesia micra, is so tiny it can sit comfortably on the tip of a human finger.
- The smell of freshly cut grass is actually a plant distress call, releasing chemicals to warn other plants and attract beneficial insects.
- Butterflies taste with their feet, using chemoreceptors to find host plants and nectar.
- The first successful photograph of a human being was taken in 1838, by Louis Daguerre, and features a man having his shoes shined.
- Bananas are technically berries, while strawberries are not, botanically speaking.
- The only letter that does not appear in the periodic table of elements is J.
- The 'richest' soil in the world is found in the Amazon rainforest, supporting incredible biodiversity.

On this day

Day 280 of the year, 85 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Justina of Padua; Christian feast day: Henry Muhlenberg (some Lutheran Churches, Episcopal Church of the USA); Christian feast day: Osgyth; Christian feast day: Our Lady of the Rosary. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1978 — Omar Benson Miller, American actor
- 1997 — Kira Kosarin, American actress and singer
- 1964 — Paul Stewart, English footballer
- 1986 — Bree Olson, American actress, model, and former pornographic actress
- 1997 — Nicole Maines, American actress, writer, and activist
- 1937 — Chet Powers, American singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 1994)
- 1974 — Allison Munn, American actress
- 1938 — Ann Jones, English tennis player and sportscaster

THE DAY TODAY

- 1978 — Aeroflot Flight 1080 crashes after takeoff from Koltsovo International Airport, killing 38.
- 1987 — Sikh nationalists declare the independence of Khalistan from India; it is not internationally recognized.
- 2004 — Three bombs explode at Taba and Nuweiba in the Sinai Peninsula, Egypt, killing 34.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2004 — Three bombs explode at Taba and Nuweiba in the Sinai Peninsula, Egypt, killing 34.
- 2016 — In the wake of Hurricane Matthew, the death toll rises to over 800.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1985 — Four men from the Palestine Liberation Front hijack the MS Achille Lauro off the coast of Egypt.
- 1987 — Sikh nationalists declare the independence of Khalistan from India; it is not internationally recognized.
- 1979 — Swissair Flight 316 crashes at Ellinikon International Airport in Athens, Greece, killing 14.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 281 of the year, 84 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Evodus (or Yves); Christian feast day: Blessed John Adams; Christian feast day: Palatias and Laurentia; Christian feast day: Pelagia (Eastern Orthodox and Roman Catholic Churches). Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1950 — Robert "Kool" Bell, American singer-songwriter and bass player
- 1950 — Blake Morrison, English poet, author, and academic
- 1961 — Kim Wayans, American actress and comedian
- 1968 — Emily Procter, American actress
- 1985 — Bruno Mars, American singer-songwriter, producer, and actor
- 1993 — Angus T. Jones, American actor
- 1956 — Stephanie Zimbalist, American actress
- 1995 — G Herbo, American rapper

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1990 — First Intifada: Israeli police kill 17 Palestinians and wound over 100 near the Dome of the Rock.
- 2001 — U.S. president George W. Bush announces the establishment of the Office of Homeland Security.
- 1978 — Australia's Ken Warby sets the current world water speed record of 275.97 knots at Blowering Dam, Australia.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1952 — The Harrow and Wealdstone rail crash in England kills 112 people.
- 1982 — Poland bans Solidarity and all other trade unions.

Coming to cinemas

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16 Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar